

Reading with a language tutor

This sample PDF fixture carries a real text layer, so a parser can read it without any optical character recognition. The paragraphs below are long enough to be split into more than one fragment by the chunker.

A learner who reads a page a day will finish a short novel in a season. The trick is not the volume of the text but the regularity of the habit. Ten minutes every morning beat three hours once a month, because a language is a set of reflexes and reflexes are built by repetition, not by effort.

When you meet an unknown word, read the whole sentence again before you reach for a dictionary. Most of the time the sentence already tells you what the word means, and a meaning you reconstructed yourself is much harder to forget than a meaning somebody handed to you.

Speaking is the part that people postpone the longest. It helps to start with texts you have already read: retell one paragraph out loud, slowly, and do not stop to correct yourself in the middle of a sentence. Correct the sentence after you finish it, and then say the whole thing once more.

At the end of the week, look back at what you read. Pick the five words you met most often and write one sentence with each of them. That is the whole method, and it fits on a single page of a sample PDF fixture.